

Planner / PM

Owens the configuration plan — turning a customer's requirements into a manufacturable, executable job before parts ever hit a machine.

PRE-PRODUCTION

“ My job as a planner is to get the parts through my own QA first — the client's inspection is round two.

WHO THEY ARE

The Planner / Project Manager turns a work order into a complete configuration plan: operations, machines, sequence, work-holding, setup and run targets, material, and outside processing. They serve two customers at once — their own quality system first, then the client's incoming QA — and coordinate across scheduling, purchasing, OSP, quality, and programming so every job is finalized, resourced, and ready to run on time.

In small shops this is the owner running everything A-to-Z. In larger shops it's a dedicated PM or planner with, as they put it, 'all the responsibility and none of the authority' — collaboration is the entire job.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

- Notify** Scrubs the System Agent inbox for new POs and PM alerts — uses it as a live task list.
- Prioritize** Reads the Project Manager dashboard (the 'thousand-foot view') and cross-checks Customer Service for what ships this week.
- Digest** Reads the PO, T&Cs, quality specs, and print revision; works the **pre-planning checklist** top to bottom.
- Configure** Builds the config plan — operations, machines, targets, work-holding, material spec, OSP flow-down.
- Schedule** Sets must-leave-by and must-be-back-on dates; flows demand to Purchasing.
- Finalize** Finalizes the WO — kicks it to the programming queue. **If it ain't green, it ain't on the machine.**

SNAPSHOT

Workflow stage	Pre-production
Serves	Internal QMS + client QA
Finalize target	24–48 hours
Ready-to-run	By 72 hours
Coordinates with	5+ departments

ENVIRONMENT & TECH COMFORT

Desk-based but constantly context-switching across dashboards. Power user who lives in red/yellow/green status cues and drills into work orders all day. Wants dense information visible at a glance, and gets frustrated by 'mental gymnastics' to piece a picture together.

Software proficiency	High
Manufacturing depth	High
Tolerance for slow drill-downs	Low

IN THEIR WORDS

“The cost of getting this wrong shows up at setup — the most expensive moment in machining. A missed tool, a wrong material cutoff, and the spindle stops.”

WHAT DRIVES THEM — AND WHAT GETS IN THE WAY

The lens Product & Design should hold when building for this user: what they're trying to achieve, where the current experience fails them, and what they need from the product to succeed.

● GOALS

- Reduce the risk of false starts at setup — the shop's most expensive moment.
- Get every job through internal QA before customer QA ever sees it.
- Hit 95%+ on-time delivery consistently, by client and by PM.
- Level-load work across the PM team so no one is drowning.

● FRUSTRATIONS

- Dashboards take 'mental gymnastics' — there's no dependency / pipeline view.
- The Late dashboard flags what's late but not *why* — every WO needs a drill-in.
- The pre-planning checklist wipes clean on finalize — timestamps are lost.
- Budget arrives already set by the estimate — variances are hard to unwind mid-job.

● NEEDS FROM PROSHOP

- A dependency / Gantt view so blockers are visible without drilling into each WO.
- 'Why is this late' surfaced on the Late dashboard, not buried in the record.
- PO due dates on hover, so purchasing status is readable at a glance.
- Preserved checklist history — keep the timestamps after finalize.

THE NUMBERS THEY'RE MEASURED ON

95% OTD

On-time delivery to the client; vendors held to a higher 97% bar.

Time-to-floor

Finalize in 24–48h, ready-to-run by 72h.

NCR count

Did we mitigate risk correctly before the job ran?

Variance

Estimated vs. actual cost and time, by work order.

PROSHOP MODULES THEY LIVE IN

Sales & Work Orders **HOME**

Visual Work Instructions **HOME**

Shop Floor & Scheduling **HOME**

Inventory & Material Planning **READS**

Job Costing & Financial Data **READS**

WHERE THEY SIT IN THE FLOW

UPSTREAM

Order Entry

Hands over the created work order

WORK ORDER



THIS PERSONA

Planner / PM

Builds & finalizes the configuration plan

READY WO



DOWNSTREAM

Buyer & Programming

Receive demand + the finalized job

ProShop is a configuration-management platform, and the Planner builds the configuration. Finalizing a WO both queues it for programming and creates the purchasing demand the Buyer sees — so an empty status-date field means the Buyer never sees the need.

Source: ProShop persona sessions + product docs. On-time-delivery targets are representative benchmarks cited in-session.

Authored and updated 8/27/2026 by Samantha Jorgenson, Product Operations Manager

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